

Liking-Relatability

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Introduction

Welcome to the third module in the Copywriting 101 course. In this module, we're going to cover how to create trust in your audience. Without trust, selling becomes extremely hard, if not impossible — meaning the following concepts are incredibly important when it comes to selling anything online.

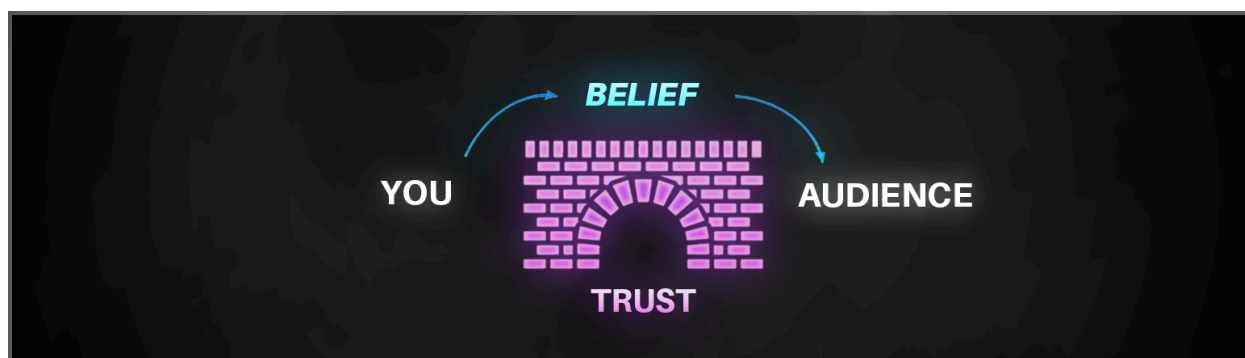
DISCLAIMER: I highly recommend watching every previous module before watching this module, as we'll be building on the concepts we learned there. If you don't understand those concepts in depth, applying the concepts you'll learn here will be harder and more complicated.

Link to the FULL video version: [Liking-Relatability Video](#)

Link to the mastersheet: [Copywriting Mastersheet](#)

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The Bridge Of Trust



'Sales is a transference of belief over a bridge of trust.' - Alex Hormozi

People buy from other people/brands that they like & trust.

If people don't like & trust you, it doesn't matter how 'good' your copy/sales message is...

They won't buy.

Because of this, creating trust is one of the most important concepts in this course.

Example:

> Imagine someone you love and trust deeply, they've never lied or led you astray, calls you and all they say is 'You HAVE to buy this thing, it's amazing, it's worth the money and it'll make your life better.' There's a high probability you'll buy it.

> On the flipside, let's imagine some sleazy guy you remember from school comes up to you. He's lied to you and your friends before, and you don't trust him. He gives you this elaborate sales pitch on the same product. He has all the witty responses to your objections and sells this thing like crazy. From a sales point of view, he's crushed it, but there's still a very low chance you buy from him. You don't like him & you don't trust him. It doesn't matter what he says.

Oftentimes, us copywriters/marketers get all tied up in the 'funnels' and 'selling tactics' and forget the most obvious question...

Does our audience even like and trust us????

In future modules, we'll dive deep into crafting compelling sales messages and a chain of beliefs to make buying your product/service irresistible...

But none of that matters if your audience doesn't like/trust you — *hence why this module comes first!*

WARNING: *The following principles are extremely powerful and should not be taken lightly. These principles have been used to start the world's largest brands, but have also created cults leading to the death of their followers. Before continuing, please promise me you'll devote your new power to good, and not evil. Sell products and concepts that bring good to the world, not evil.*

The 11 Variables Of Likeness

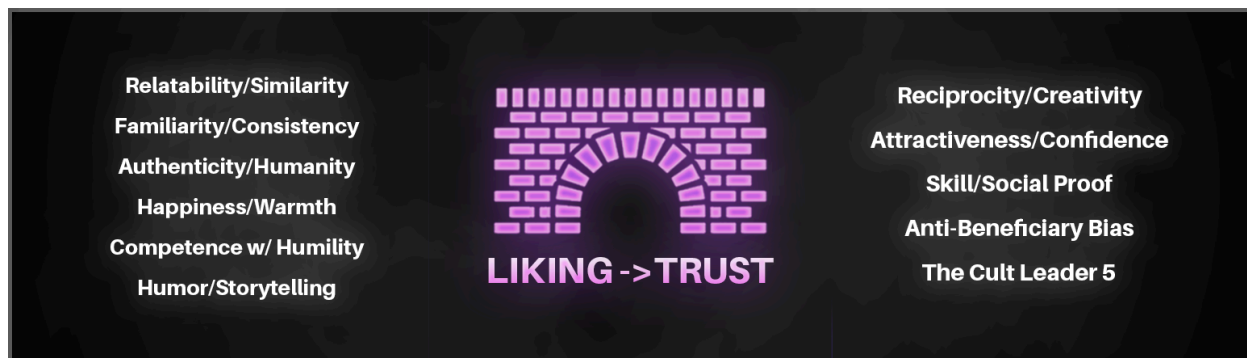
The Liking Principle: The liking principle suggests that we are more likely to be influenced by people we like or feel a connection with.

Translation: *We're more likely to trust people we like.*

In Robert Cialdini's book 'Influence', he describes how people prefer to say 'yes' to those that they like. Multiple studies have shown this to not only be true, but to be one of, if not, the MOST important, variables when it comes to someone making a purchasing decision.

After studying countless books on psychology and persuasion, and applying these concepts in the current digital landscape, I can confidently say... he is 100% correct. Liking is everything.

That's why I want to share with you the **'11 Variables of Likeness'**. When you focus on leveraging these variables, you'll find that your audience will begin to fall in love with you/your client.



Let's go over each principle one by one, and then some examples/practical applications for each:

1. Relatability/Similarity

> **We like people we relate to.** Those who share the same 'feelings' (internal) as we do — *people/brands who 'get us' and understand what 'we're going through'.*

(They understand how I feel. They've felt how I'm feeling. They know me.)

> **We like people we are similar to.** Those who share the same 'traits' (external) as we do — *people who look, think, and are in the same situations as we are.*

(They share the same background [age, hometown, culture], same interests [sports, music, hobbies], same opinions or values, or similar appearance or social status.)

The more your audience believes you **FEEL** how they **FEEL**, **LIKE** the things they **LIKE**, and **LOOK/TALK**, the way they **LOOK/TALK**... *the more they'll like & trust you.*

Examples:

- *Memes*
- *When you talk about someone's 'Specific Conditions' they feel understood/similar to you/your brand.*
- *Using similar language, talking about similar interests, similar hatreds/enemies, similar clothes, similar accent, etc.*

2. Familiarity/Consistency

> **We like things we're familiar with.** Familiarity feels safe. Our brains are wired to prefer what we recognize — faces, names, style, accent — because, based on past experiences, it's less likely to be a threat and more likely to be rewarding.

This is known as the "mere exposure effect" in psychology:

The more we're exposed to something (*even subconsciously*), the more we tend to like it, just because it's familiar.

> **Consistency creates predictable familiarity.** When someone sees you show up in the same way — same appearance, same energy, same values — they begin to feel they know you and can trust you, even if they don't really 'know' you that well, or at all.

Remember from the last module. Predictability feels SAFE. People trust what they can predict. When you're consistent, you feel SAFER than someone/some brand that is inconsistent.

Examples:

- Family
- Advertising (*Cheezits commercial lol*)
- Daily uploads
- Same niche, same offer, same product
- Race
- Ford VS Chevy Trucks
- KJ Odablock example

3. Authenticity/Humanity

> **We like people who feel authentic.** People who seem 'real'. People who feel true to who they are, not like they're trying too hard, hiding something, or putting on an act.

(They're being themselves. It doesn't feel like they're pretending. I can trust what they're showing me.)

> **We like people who feel human/perfectly imperfect.** Since we know deep down that 'no one's perfect' (except Jesus, of course!), we naturally distrust people who appear as 'perfect'. When someone shows their humanity, it builds trust because we realize they're imperfect just like us.

(They've messed up. They get nervous. They overthink. They've failed before. They're just like me.)

The more your audience believes you're being real, not performing... and the more they see your human 'imperfections'... the more they'll like and trust you.

Examples:

- Talking about your past failures (*bonus points if it's relatable/similar to their failures*)
- Using your real voice, not corporate speak or 'perfect grammar'
- Laughing at yourself, showing mistakes in real time
- Showing and saying how you don't know everything.'

WARNING: Authentic DOES NOT mean oversharing. It DOES NOT mean showing everyone everything. There's aura/attractiveness in mystery. Being authentic is choosing to share *certain* moments, not sharing everything. It's a delicate balance, i.e. ' *Don't record yourself pooping.*'

- CE Q1 Example

These principles lead to a feeling of SAFETY. When people see you as human and authentic/honest, they feel safer around you, leading to likeness and trust.

4. Happiness/Warmth

> We prefer to be happy over sad. Therefore, we like people who make us feel happy. People who smile, who give off 'light' and feel 'light' (less stressed). These people are often described as 'warm'. Warm people make us feel happy, safe, and accepted for who we are.

(Think of people/friends who are 'easy' to be around. You'd prefer being with them most of the time than without them.)

We like people who seem to enjoy life. People who laugh easily, don't take everything too seriously, and can show gratitude, excitement, or joy. Happiness is contagious, which is why we prefer to be around them.

The more your audience sees you as 'warm', non-judgmental, and genuinely happy, the more they'll like and trust you.

Examples:

- Golden retrievers
- Smile
- Voice (speed, volume, rhythm, accent, confidence, etc)
- Calmness
- (wHy sO SeRious??)
- Body language
- R.B.F (resting b face)
- Neal Caffery from 'White Collar'
- Telling warm/happy stories
- Taking freeze frames of sales calls.

People usually forget what you said, but they remember how you made them feel.

Warmth = you leave them feeling better than you found them.

5. Competence w/ Humility

> We like people who are generally successful in what they set out to do. People who don't rely on others for every little thing in their lives. They just know how to get stuff done. Competent people tend to attract others who want to find 'safety' in that competence.

Even if they don't have the answers, you trust they'll be able to find them.

(They seem to 'get it'. I trust them. I want to follow their lead.)

But competence isn't just IQ or book-smarts. It's not about 'knowing' a bunch of useless crap, using big words or knowing facts.

> Real competence is 'street-smarts' — the ability to solve problems, get results, and make things happen in the real world. Not just on paper.

(They've actually done it. They've been through it. They can actually help me win — this is why college degrees can be misleading!)

But competence can quickly lead to dislike as soon as you become prideful/arrogant.

> We like humble people. Humility isn't thinking less of yourself, it's simply focusing on others. People who are arrogant and only think about themselves is a huge 'turn-off' for an audience.

Don't be fooled. Arrogant people might get a lot of 'attention' (*likes, views, comments, etc.*) but they don't build TRUST like a truly humble person — *and trust sells*.

We're drawn to people who are 'quietly' powerful. People like to *know* you're powerful... without you *telling* them. (*When your results/reputation/competence speaks for itself.*)

The more your audience sees you as competent but humble, the more they'll like and trust you.

Examples:

- 'How I' not 'How to'
- Sam Sulek
- Shedeur Sanders VS Travis Hunter (great example of views ≠ trust)
\$446,553 vs \$30.5 million
- The ultimate example: **JESUS** (see 'Mindset Course' for full deep-dive)

6. Humor/Storytelling

> We like/remember people who make us 'feel' something — *especially if that feeling is 'happy' or 'engaged/flow state'.*

That's why humor and storytelling is OP for making people like/trust you. When you use humor to make people laugh, they remember feeling happy around you. When you tell great stories people are 'engaged'.

In both cases, your audience's brain releases dopamine, signalling that they 'enjoyed' being around you.

(An entire course could be written on just storytelling alone, but for now just remember that humor & stories create heightened emotions in our audience, leaving them feeling a deeper connection with you and your message.)

Humor makes you likable and stories make you memorable.

Examples:

- Movies/TV
- Comedians
- Your fav youtubers
- Songs

7. Reciprocity/Creativity

> The reciprocity principle is one of the basic laws of social psychology: It says that in many social situations we pay back what we received from others.

Translation: We tend to like and feel like we 'owe' someone who has given us something. Those who offer value without immediately asking for something back. Giving first builds goodwill — it makes people want to return the favor, even subconsciously.

> Creativity works hand in hand with reciprocity because when you take the time to truly create something unique/valuable, people feel more reciprocity and the urge to pay you back is stronger.

(Wow, that was awesome. I can't believe that was free. I feel guilty getting that for so cheap.)

The more you show up with generosity and creativity — offering useful, thoughtful, or unexpected value — *the more people will like, remember, and trust you.*

Examples:

- YouTube organic
- Settled creativity example
- Lead magnets
- Free trainings
- Costco free samples
- When someone pays for your food

8. Attractiveness/Confidence

> We are more likely to trust/like people who are physically attractive.

It's in the definition: '*attractive*'-ness. We're drawn to good-looking people.

Every principle we've discussed in this module can play a role in your overall 'attractiveness', but just remember that *physical* attractiveness is kinda a cheat code to influence.

We can't all be Brad Pitt, but the lesson here is try to look decent when you show up anywhere online lol.

> We like confident people.

This one is simple. It ties right back into the 'SAFE' emotion from the 'Text-Subtext' module. We feel safe around confident people. We want to be led by people who feel confident in their own skin and confident in their abilities.

(Think about it, why would you place your confidence in someone who isn't even confident in themselves?)

Just remember, arrogance isn't the same as confidence. You can be confident in yourself without being boastful. Remember the humility principle.

Examples:

- The popular kid in school
- Actors
- Musicians
- Writers who write with confidence
- TED Talks / speakers who speak with confidence

9. Skill/Social Proof

> We like people who are extremely skilled at what they do — *even if it's a skill we aren't interested in or we don't find that 'useful'.*

If someone is 'best in the world' at something (*even if it's 'useless'*) we naturally see them as having a heightened level of 'aura'.

This is because we ascribe more value to things that are scarce. If there's only ONE person that is THAT good in the entire world at that thing, we see them as valuable.

Example: *You hear that an 'olympic gold medalist' is living in your town, even if they're a gold medalist in the stupidest sport ever, you'd still find it pretty cool lol.*

Skill also signals 'safety' and 'confidence'. If someone is very skilled at the thing they do, you're more likely to trust that they can get results.

Skill usually leads to having social proof.

> Social proof in persuasion is a psychological phenomenon where individuals are influenced by the actions and beliefs of others to make decisions.

Translation: We're more likely to like/do stuff that other people like/do.

Basically, instead of going through the pain of critically thinking for yourself to come to a conclusion on your own, you rely on the actions of others as a guide for how to behave.

(You're more likely to follow someone with 1M followers, rather than 100, because subconsciously you think: 'Well, if a million people are already following them, then they're probably worth following.')

Examples:

- Athletes
- Artists
- Speedrunners (Mario Kart / Minecraft)
- People with lots of followers
- Passing the '10k sub ceiling' on youtube
- 'We've helped 75+ copywriters...'
- The anti-example of youtubers with the 'subscribe' metrics

10. Anti-Beneficiary Bias (Non-Neediness)

> We like people who don't seem like they *need* to be liked — *people who are 'non-needy'.*

This can be explained by what I call the anti-beneficiary bias:

> Anti-Beneficiary Bias: We are 'less trusting' of people who have *more* to gain from an exchange than ourselves, because the more they have to gain, the higher chance they'll act unethically.

Imagine you see Bill Gates on the street and he hands you a \$100 bill. Now imagine a homeless man stops you on the street and gives you a \$100 bill. Who are you less trusting of?

The more 'non-needy' you are, the more trusting people will naturally be. Non-neediness also signals confidence & competence, which makes your counterpart in the exchange feel safer.

Examples:

- My personal YouTube examples
- Editing breakthroughs
- Relationships

11. The Cult Leader 5

Blair Warren, a fellow lifelong student of persuasion, writes in his book 'One-Sentence Persuasion' that there is one sentence that can explain the most influential movements in human history:

> People will do anything for those who encourage their dreams, justify their failures, allay their fears, confirm their suspicions, and help them throw rocks at their enemies.

This is what I refer to as *The Cult Leader 5*. I've given it this label for a reason. It's as powerful as it sounds and shouldn't be taken lightly. When using these 5 angles in your marketing, you need to be careful — *these are real people's lives that you're influencing*.

Let's take a deeper look at the 5:

1. Encourage Their Dreams

- a. Most of us had big dreams and ambitions as kids. Somewhere in our lives, our parents, teachers, and/or friends tell us to 'be reasonable' and let go of these big dreams — *to settle for average, and play it safe*. When someone comes to tell us that we CAN achieve those dreams and encourages us to shoot for the stars and take the risk, we can be very easily influenced by them. Think about it. We WANT them to be right, so we tell ourselves that they are.

2. Justify Their Failures

- a. Although deep down we 'know' that we have to assume responsibility for our actions and the situation we're in in our life, *we don't like it lol*. It's so much easier to blame someone else or something else. When people tell us it's 'not our fault' and it's 'because of something else', we naturally want to believe them.

3. Allay Their Fears

- a. We hate being scared or feeling in danger. Even if someone doesn't 'solve' the problem or make the danger go away, if they make us 'feel' safer... we want to trust them. When you're scared, you want to be with someone who distracts you from those fears or makes them feel non-existent. We don't want to be around someone who heightens our awareness of those fears.

4. Confirm Their Suspicions

- a. We love being 'right.' We love saying 'I knew it!' and 'I told you so!'. This makes it easy for someone to leverage this to influence us. When someone confirms the suspicions you already have, you feel 'attached' to that person and want to trust them. This is a cult-leader classic. They confirm the suspicions of their members, saying 'Your family is out to get you!' which makes the followers fall more in love with the cult and abandon their families.

5. Throw Rocks At Their Enemies

- a. The enemy of our enemy is our friend. We like 'hating' on people. When someone throws shade on someone we already don't like, we get excited. We immediately feel like a 'friend' to that person. Like we're 'on the same side'. This is extremely powerful. You see this DAILY in politics, YouTube drama, everywhere.

If you're feeling a bit overwhelmed, don't worry! We're going to cover many examples of each principle in action within a full marketing effort. Also, it's impossible to develop a deep understanding of these in a day. It'll take some time. All great things do. But be excited, because now that you've been shown these principles, you'll start to see them EVERYWHERE. Your life will never be the same. You'll start to realize why you like certain people/brands and then transfer those insights/tactics into your own marketing. Exciting. 😊

Bonus points if you noticed what I did there (;

Leveraging Likeness

Now let's talk about how to integrate these principles into your copy.

In 'Text-Subtext' we discussed how to leverage the **subtext** of your copy to push the big four general emotions, but once you've decided **what** emotion to push, you now need to decide **how** to push it.

You need to choose the best text to convey that subtext.

This is where we can leverage the **11 variables to likeness** in the text, the 'how' we push the emotions.

There is a limited amount of **emotions** you can push (**subtext**) but there are an infinite number of ways you can push them. (text)

Here's an example:

> Subtext (*Emotion We're Trying To Push*):

- 'Wow, that's seems easy and safe'

> Text (*How We Could Push It*):

- 'We even had a 17-year old from Portugal sign a client 1 month after using this system.'
- 'After 45 copywriters used this system, only 1 person didn't sign a client... (and that's because that 1 person became so skilled from our copy course that clients started reaching out to him before he started outreach.)'
- 'We built this system with one principle in mind... So easy a monkey could sign a client. And my lil brother got a client using so that means we're pretty close LOL'

There are a million ways you can push the same **emotions**.

The secret is picking the **BEST** way to push the emotion that creates **the most likeness/trust** in your audience.

The 'Price Is Right' Framework

When choosing the 'text' I'm going to go with, I like to imagine I'm playing the 'Price Is Right' game show. (*Example for you yougin's.*)



Like the game show, no matter what the wheel landed on, he would have made some money. But if he gets the right number... he could win big.

The same is true for our copy.

Every word has an emotion/feeling tied to it and tells it's own little story. It's your job to find the perfect words and their arrangement for your audience.

Example (*The Adweek Copywriting Handbook*):

- *An old woman in a motel.*
- *Little old lady in a cottage.*

There are multiple ways to say the same 'thing'. Notice the different emotions/story with each one.

When you push the perfect emotions (subtext) using the best selection of words possible (text) — magic happens.

Here's how we do it:

1. **Step 1: Finding Specific Conditions** - if you don't have clear and accurate specific conditions of the audience you're speaking to, it's going to be very hard/if not impossible to choose the most effective 'text' (way) to push emotions.

(You can still push the emotions, it will just sound very 'vanilla'/generic because you'll have to play it safe since you don't know exactly who you're writing to.)

2. **Step 2: Choosing The Subtext** - The next step is deciding WHICH emotion(s) you're trying to push with this section of copy.

3. **Step 3: Choosing The Text** - The final step is testing a bunch of different ways to push that emotion. Declining HOW you're going to push the emotion(s) you're trying to push. The key is to write a ton of different examples, then put yourself in the mind of your audience (by studying your specific conditions deck) and decide which one you think will resonate more with them.

Real KJ Example: https://miro.com/app/board/uXjVIPFMHLk=?share_link_id=510609643361

The power comes from effectively integrating **11 Variables of Likeness** in step three.

Let's look at a few examples:

> **Relatability** (*Pain Bullet*)

- Before: *You're life sucks.*
- After: *You survived school, but the 9-5 grind is killing you from the inside out. You can't imagine doing this for another year, let alone 40. What you learned in school isn't useful. You feel completely replaceable. I've been there, man.*

> **Familiarity** (*Offer Headline*)

- Before: *Sign 3-5 Business Owners Using Our Proven Acquisition System*
- After: *Sign 3-5 Copywriting Clients Using Our Proven Outreach System*

> **Authenticity** (*Reaffirming/Allaying Fears*)

- Before: *If that sounds like you right now, don't worry.*
- After: *If that's you rn... I've got your back brother.*

> **Humor** (*Easy emotion around mechanism*)

- Before: *This system is so easy to run, even a monkey could do it!*
- After: *We built this system with one goal in mind: Make it so easy a monkey could sign a client with it. (And my lil brother got a client using so that means we're pretty close LOL.)*

> **Storytelling** (*Relating to their pain*)

- Before: *I've been there too. I was broke and dumb.*
- After: *(Tell a specific story that shows how dumb and broke you were. Ie: you sold your car for gas money. LOL)*

> **Confidence** (*Pushing Big*)

- Before: *This could be a big opportunity for you.*

- After: *This opportunity will change your life FOREVER. I say this with 100% certainty because it radically changed my life.*

These are just a few of the endless ways you can integrate these principles to power up your copy.

With some practice, you'll find integrating these principles will not only become second nature, but you'll have so much fun creatively adding them in new ways no one has done before.

Full-Funnel Likeness

Due to their quantity, these principles can be a bit overwhelming at first. Don't stress it. It'll take some time for you to master them all, but you're already ahead of 99.9% of marketers just by knowing they exist.

The best thing you can do is to start slowly implementing them into your marketing as a whole.

To make these principles as simple as possible to implement, I've added the '11 Variables of Likeness' to your *Conditions Deck*.

>  *Conditions Deck [TEMPLATE]*

SECTION 5 | Variables of Likeness

1. What words/phrases/examples/stories can you use in your marketing/copy to be more relatable/similar to your audience?
2. How can you be more familiar/consistent with your audience?
3. What are some failures/imperfections you can share with your audience that would make you more authentic/human to your audience?
4. How can you appear happier/warmer when engaging with your audience?
5. How can you show your audience you're competent without directly telling them/being arrogant?
6. Where/how can you use humor and stories in your copy/marketing?
7. How can you use reciprocity/creativity to give dope free value to your audience?
8. How can you be more attractive/confident in your marketing?
9. How can you display your skill without being arrogant? How can you leverage what social proof you have?
10. Are you ensuring you're being 'non-needy' in your marketing/copy? (Writing/speaking in a way that seems like you don't really care whether they take the action or not.)
11. How can you use the Cult Leader 5:
 - a. What dreams do they have, and how can you encourage them?
 - b. What failures do they have, and how can you blame them on something/someone else?
 - c. What fears do they have, and how can you allay those fears and make them feel safe?

- d. What suspensions do they have, and how can you confirm those suspicions?
- e. What common enemies do you have, and how can you throw rocks at those enemies?

Now let's go over some examples of these principles at work in the marketing from some popular influencers you might be familiar with:

EXAMPLE BOARD

- > Hamza (Personal Brand)
- > Dan Koe (Personal Brand)
- > Blume (Ecom Brand)
- > Apple (Tech Brand)
- > MintMobile (Ryan Reynold's Cell Company)

A great way to learn these principles is by searching for them in people/brands that you like.

Complete this exercise by the end of the week:

1. Write down 3 brands/people that you really like.
2. Use this [Miro Template](#) to find how they use these principles.
3. Write down tactics you learned from them you might be able to use in your copy/marketing.

That will give you a great head start on learning how these concepts play into a full marketing strategy. Well done.

Quick Reminder:

If you want me to crank more modules like this one, and even better, let me know any wins/breakthroughs/thoughts you have on this module/course in the #★course-wins channel in the Discord. It gives me so much energy to know all the pain I go through making these is worth it haha. Love y'all and see you in the next module. ❤️ -KJ

Link to the FULL video version: [Liking-Relatability Video](#)

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:)